

TUESDAY, APRIL 16, 1957

THE INDIANAPOLIS STAR

PAGE 27

New Indian Chief, Players Battle Millers



WHICH IS ANDY'S CHOICE? Al Papa (left) and Barry Latman (right) watch on. Manager Andy Cohen looks into the horseshoe to see which will be the Indian.

EGGERT'S BILLBOARD

Long Ron, He's The Tallest

By BILL EGGERT

ALL the blackeyes baseball took during the off-season haven't faded the game a bit. If anything, it's getting more attention.

Can you imagine delicious phone calls yesterday warning the Baltimore Wash in a ton score. You'd think there was a World Series going on. The police haven't shared the pool ticket operators.

Washington and Baltimore are a pair of tangled sheets that won't see daylight all season. They couldn't whip the Yankee B team yet they are a part of increased general interest in all baseball.

The game, hushed and cold until it's practically unapproachable by federal legislation, is "big business" but its characters are a mixture of intellectuality, muscular heroism and by-products of a way of living. But it's the greatest game of them all.

See you at Victory Field? And when you take in the Indians' games this season you can't help but at first base—probably the tallest man in American Association history to be stationed at the getaway sack. He's Ron Jackson, a hunk of 6-7 plebeian. He's only 23 years old, can hit the long ball and is exceptionally agile for a giant. Any infielder missing that target should be charged with two errors.

AFTER 50 baseball owners you'd think a man could arm himself against first-day jitters. Apparently it isn't true. Owner Bush, the Tribe's president, has the jitters about the Indians' tonight. He wants it out of the way so he can get down to the serious stuff of improving writers.

INDIANS' OPENER
TONIGHT
at 7:45 P.M.
Indianapolis vs. Minneapolis
ALL SEATS RESERVED
GET TICKETS TODAY

Victory Field Box Office
or Bill and Sam's, Capital Hotel

Indianapolis vs. Minneapolis
at 7:45 P.M.

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apola pitcher in tonight's opener, Thor's a knuckballer, Papa's favorite pitch, and a fastball Cohen is demonstrating.

Cohen Delays Mound Choice

Tonight's Lineups

MINNEAPOLIS MILLERS
Felipe Alou, cf
Wase Fawell, 2b
Bank Thompson, lf
Carlos Paula, rf
Orlando Cepeda, 1b
Jim Davenport, 3b
Ed Breunert, ss
Jake Jenkins, c
Stu Miller, p

INDIANAPOLIS INDIANS
Dick Means, cf
Vince Garcia, 2b
Ted Beard, rf
Ron Jackson, lf
Don Prohovich, 1b
Jim Deling, 3b
Charlie Williams, ss
John Romano, c
Barry Latman, p
Al Papa, p

Minneapolis Manager—Red Davis
Indianapolis Manager—Andy Cohen

By MAX GREENWALD

A parade and pageantry. Beauty queens and dignitaries.

They all are part of the biggest program in Indianapolis history for the opening of the baseball season. But at 7:45 o'clock tonight at Victory Field, the hoopla will be over and the Indianapolis Indians will get down to the business of seeing what they can do about the American Association race.

The community-owned club has not caught the eye of old timers in other cities, long picked for seventh place in the pregame voting by the league's writers.

THIS IS FAR from the showing of the 1956 team which made a late-season runaway for the pennant, then swept through the playoffs and the Little World Series.

Kerly Farrell, who managed Tribe pennant winners in 1954 and '56, has left for the more lush pastures of the major leagues. Gone, too, are the star second-line players of the Cleveland organization as the fifth-year alignment was broken.

In their place are Andy Cohen, who has been a successful manager in lower minor leagues, and players from the Chicago White Sox with which Indianapolis now is linked.

There may be redrafts next fall among these polefolds who condemned these Indians to second-division status.

In exhibition play, the Tribe didn't have an abundance of power but it had fine pitching, much of it from rookies.

One of them, Barry Latman, has been mentioned as the starter against Minneapolis tonight but Cohen still may go one of his veterans, Al Papa.

"I don't want to play cat and mouse about the first game pitcher," Cohen said yesterday as the Indians were at the park for the first time for practice and picture-taking. "But I'd rather wait before definitely making my choice."

Papa has been a successful minor league pitcher in 17 seasons while Latman, just 29 years old, was the sensation of the exhibition, striking out 19 batters in 27 innings.

CATCHER John Romano and First Baseman Ron Jackson are expected to be the power boys of the squad. Dependable Vince Garcia will be at second base; Charlie Williams, a handyman infielder, at shortstop, and Don Prohovich at third. Prohovich, another fine prospect of the White Sox, has been at short but is being moved while arrival of Jose Valdivia is awaited.

Valdivia, optioned to the Indians by Washington, left the Senators yesterday and will make it by game time.

With Stu Miller, a right-hander, slated to pitch for Minneapolis, Cohen will use his left-handed lineup outfield trio of Dick Means, Jim Deling and Ted Beard.

Harry Gabel was master of ceremonies and other speakers were Bay, Johnson and Bob Kirby, Indians, Inc. president.

Our 1957 Marquess sell tickets in and you'll see why.

STRICKLAND MERCURY, INC.
3327 N. ILLINOIS ST.
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SAVE ON FAMILY 1/2-FARE DAYS

TONIGHT'S STARTERS—Out of the dugout come tonight's starters for Indianapolis (left to right) Dick Means, Vince Garcia, Ted Beard, Ron Jackson, Don Prohovich, Jim Deling, Charlie Williams and John Romano. (Star Photo by Herb Rhodes)

HIS HONOR-THE STARTER.....



Orioles, Not Yanks, Lead American League Race

For at least 24 hours the Baltimore Orioles can wear at the New York Yankees and the rest of the American League from their first-place perch after beating Washington, 7-6 yesterday in an 11-inning special opening game before a crowd of 23,872, including President Eisenhower.

As the weather man smiles, the Orioles' lead is 10 1/2 games over the Yankees, who are in second place. The Tribe didn't have an abundance of power but it had fine pitching, much of it from rookies.

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SAVE ON FAMILY 1/2-FARE DAYS

Scribes Pick Denver To Cop Pennant

By BILL EGGERT

THE Denver Bears, third in 1955 and second in 1956, will take it all this year according to the consensus conclusion of the 19 baseball writers who submitted guesses on the 1957 American Association pennant race.

As the scribes see it, Wichita and Omaha will provide the chief resistance to the Denver pick, with Minneapolis and St. Paul also getting in their licks.

Charleson was picked to retain its sixth place finish of 1956 with Indianapolis and Louisville rounding out the field.

Clubs consigned to the lower realm can draw solace and inspiration from so recent an event as the 1956 pennant race in which Indianapolis, a solid choice for sixth, not only won the pennant but also registered the first four-game sweep in Little World Series history.

Max Greenwald, the Star's baseball writer, picked Indianapolis to finish fourth. He selected St. Paul to be first, Minneapolis second, Denver third, and Charleson, Omaha and Louisville.

Denver received nine first-place votes for 131 points. Other point totals in the consensus: Wichita 115, Omaha 105, Minneapolis 101, St. Paul 94, Charleson 82, Indianapolis 37 and Louisville 23.

Yesterday's Results

Baltimore 7, Washington 6 (11 innings)

Today's Schedule

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION

Indianapolis vs. Minneapolis 7:45 P.M.

St. Paul vs. Chicago 7:45 P.M.

Omaha vs. Louisville 7:45 P.M.

Wichita vs. Denver 7:45 P.M.

Charleson vs. St. Paul 7:45 P.M.

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